



March 8th 2018 Delaware County CAFO Informative Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=KjB44gnXbsI
Publication Date	2018-05-07T19:13:19Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report: Delaware County Commissioners

1. Pre-Hearing & Rules Explanation

- **Session Type & Topic:** [00:01:49](#) Procedural hearing and rules explanation regarding a proposed Confined Feeding Operation (CFO) project by the Light family.
- **Summary of Discussion:** Presiding officials outlined the rules for public comment and presentations. Each side (proponents and opponents) was granted a maximum of 45 minutes. The applicant received the first 10 minutes to present the project, followed by designated speakers from both sides. Written comments were accepted up until Monday, March 12, 2018, at 4:00 p.m. at the commissioners' office or via email.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Conducted by the Delaware County Commissioners, reviewing a proposed agricultural CFO project application submitted by the Light family.
- **Attendance:**

- *Presiding Officers / Board Members:* Delaware County Commissioners (Specific individual names not formally roll-called in transcript excerpt).
 - *Staff Mentioned:* J. Honeycutt (Commissioners' Office Manager/Contact), County Building Commissioner, local highway and engineering staff.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Not detailed in the provided transcript.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Not detailed in the provided transcript.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **Item Identifier & Title:** 00:05:06 Consideration of the Light Family Confined Feeding Operation (CFO) Project Application.
- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brett Light (Applicant / Representative of the Light family farming operation).
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - *Applicant Presentation (00:05:06):* Brett Light presented the project, noting that his family has farmed in Delaware County for three generations (since 1959). The project involves constructing four barns on site, each housing over 2,600 pigs (totaling approximately 10,500-10,700 hogs), to contract out hog finishing. Light stated that the project complies with all county zoning requirements, flood plain regulations, and environmental assessments, and is necessary for the family farm's economic sustainability and future generations.
 - *Proponent Testimony:* Several local farmers and agricultural educators spoke in favor of the project, highlighting that local farming families care deeply about the environment, utilize modern technologies (such as manure injection and drag lines), comply strictly with IDEM (Indiana Department of Environmental Management) regulations, and that the project provides necessary economic support for local agriculture and infrastructure maintenance.
 - *Opponent Testimony:* Numerous residents, realtors, scientists, and local business owners spoke passionately against the project. Key concerns included:
 - **Health & Air Quality:** Emissions of toxic gases (hydrogen sulfide, ammonia), volatile organic compounds, aerosolized bacteria, antibiotics, and particulate matter affecting surrounding residents, children, and individuals with respiratory or medical vulnerabilities (e.g., lung transplants).
 - **Water & Environmental Safety:** Runoff risks into the Mississinewa River basin, proximity of application fields to waterways, and the accumulation of anaerobic bacterial sludge in manure pits.

- **Infrastructure & Economics:** Damage to narrow local roads and bridges from heavy construction and semi-truck traffic, lack of local tax benefits (noting equipment may be registered in Blackford County), and potential negative impacts on surrounding property values.
- **Local Regulation:** Criticism that Delaware County lacks up-to-date local zoning ordinances specifically regulating CFOs, leaving residents reliant solely on state oversight.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Extensive public testimony was heard from both sides, exactly exhausting the 45-minute allocation for opponents and utilizing time from proponents. Notable speakers included:
 - *Opponents:* Gary Alexander (Real Estate Broker/Appraiser) [00:08:58](#), Duke Campbell [00:14:53](#), Elizabeth Priscilla [00:21:52](#), Bob Ray [00:25:35](#), Doug Short [00:26:59](#), Connie Ray [00:30:34](#), Cindy Short [00:37:27](#), Dennis Walker [00:43:30](#), Sandy York [00:47:53](#), James Revoircheck [00:51:34](#), and Maggie Nails [00:19:21](#).
 - *Proponents:* Tom Chalfant (Randolph County Commissioner/Farmer) [00:08:09](#), John Russell [01:01:10](#), Jason Light [01:05:16](#), Mark Carter (Purdue Extension) [01:08:40](#), Eugene White [01:11:02](#), and Meredith White [01:15:38](#).
- **Action & Vote Disposition: Deferred / Under Review.** No final vote or decision was taken during this meeting. The commissioners accepted verbal testimony and set a deadline for written submissions (Monday, March 12, 2018, at 4:00 p.m.) before compiling the official record for future deliberation.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(All general public testimony regarding the CFO project was integrated directly into the substantive business hearing due to the nature of the agenda item.)

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Written materials and supplemental documentation can continue to be submitted to the commissioners' office (Room 309 at the County Building) or emailed to office manager J. Honeycutt until Monday, March 12, 2018, at 4:00 p.m.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded after all registered speakers and written submissions were processed for the record (exact final adjournment timestamp/disposition not explicitly stated in the final audio segment).
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